MASJIDAL API · DEVELOPER GUIDE

Using your Server Key

A server key lets your own backend code pull prayer timings from Masjidal. It is a secret credential — it belongs on your server and nowhere else. This guide covers where to get one, the single endpoint it opens, and how to keep it safe.

What your server key can reach

A server key is deliberately narrow. It unlocks one endpoint — the prayer timings for your masjid. Nothing else on the Masjidal platform responds to it.

ACCESSIBLE WITH A SERVER KEY	
`GET` `/timings`	Prayer timings for a date range you choose.
– Everything else	Not accessible. Requests to any other endpoint are rejected.

> **Building a website or widget instead?** Use a **frontend key** (`msj_pk_…`), not this one. Frontend keys are safe to publish in page code because they only work from the domains you allow. A server key in a web page can be read and misused by anyone.

Get your key

1. Sign in to the Masjidal portal and open **Integrations** → **API Keys**.
2. On the **Server Key** card, choose **Generate Server Key**.
3. Copy the key and store it somewhere safe straight away. It starts with `msj_sk_` and is shown **only once** — once you close that window, it cannot be displayed again.

Lost the key? Open the ⋮ menu on the card and choose **Rotate key** to get a new one. Only masjid admins can generate, rotate, or disable a server key.

The Timings endpoint

ENDPOINT

```
GET https://api.masjidal.com/timings?start_date={start}&end_date={end}
```

QUERY PARAMETERS

PARAMETER	DESCRIPTION
`start_date` required	First day of the period you want timings for, as `YYYY-MM-DD`.
`end_date` required	Last day of the period, as `YYYY-MM-DD`. Must be on or after `start_date`.

You get back timings for that period only. Ask for the range you actually need — a month at a time is usually plenty — and cache the result rather than requesting the same days on every page load.

REQUIRED HEADERS

HEADER	VALUE
`Accept`	`application/vnd.masjidal.com.v1+json` Selects version 1 of the API. Send it on every request.
`x-api-key`	`msj_sk_…` Your server key, exactly as copied — no quotes, no `Bearer` prefix.

Make a request

Each example reads the key from an environment variable called `MASJIDAL_SERVER_KEY` rather than writing it into the file — that keeps it out of your source code and out of version control.

CURL

```
curl -G "https://api.masjidal.com/timings" \
  --data-urlencode "start_date=2026-08-01" \
  --data-urlencode "end_date=2026-08-31" \
  -H "Accept: application/vnd.masjidal.com.v1+json" \
  -H "x-api-key: $MASJIDAL_SERVER_KEY"
```

NODE.JS

```
const params = new URLSearchParams({
  start_date: '2026-08-01',
  end_date: '2026-08-31',
});

const response = await fetch(`https://api.masjidal.com/timings?${params}`, {
  headers: {
    'Accept': 'application/vnd.masjidal.com.v1+json',
    'x-api-key': process.env.MASJIDAL_SERVER_KEY,
  },
});

if (!response.ok) {
  throw new Error(`Masjidal timings request failed: ${response.status}`);
}

const timings = await response.json();
```

PHP

```
$url = 'https://api.masjidal.com/timings?' . http_build_query([
    'start_date' => '2026-08-01',
    'end_date'   => '2026-08-31',
]);

$ch = curl_init($url);
curl_setopt_array($ch, [
    CURLOPT_RETURNTRANSFER => true,
    CURLOPT_HTTPHEADER => [
        'Accept: application/vnd.masjidal.com.v1+json',
        'x-api-key: ' . getenv('MASJIDAL_SERVER_KEY'),
    ],
]);

$timings = json_decode(curl_exec($ch), true);
curl_close($ch);
```

PYTHON

```python
import os
import requests

response = requests.get(
    "https://api.masjidal.com/timings",
    params={"start_date": "2026-08-01", "end_date": "2026-08-31"},
    headers={
        "Accept": "application/vnd.masjidal.com.v1+json",
        "x-api-key": os.environ["MASJIDAL_SERVER_KEY"],
    },
    timeout=10,
)
response.raise_for_status()

timings = response.json()
```

A successful request returns JSON containing the prayer timings for each day in the range you asked for.

Keeping your key safe

> **Treat your server key like a password.** Anyone who has it can pull your masjid's data. It is never shown again after you generate it, and Masjidal support cannot recover it for you.

- ✓ Keep it in an environment variable or your hosting platform's secrets manager.
- ✓ Call the API from your own backend, then pass the results to your pages.
- ✗ Never put it in website HTML or JavaScript, a mobile app, or anything a visitor can view.
- ✗ Never commit it to a Git repository, paste it into a support ticket, or send it over chat or email.
- ✗ Never share one key between organisations — each masjid uses its own.

IF A KEY IS EXPOSED

Open **Integrations** → **API Keys** and use the ⋮ menu on the Server Key card:

- **Rotate key** — issues a replacement and kills the old one immediately. Have the new key ready to paste into your server config, because anything still using the old one stops working the moment you rotate.
- **Disable key** — switches the key off for good with no replacement. Use this when you are retiring an integration. It cannot be undone; you would need to generate a fresh key to start again.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO CHECK
The request is rejected as unauthorised	The `x-api-key` header is missing, misspelled, or the value picked up stray quotes or whitespace. Confirm the key still starts with `msj_sk_` and that it hasn't been rotated or disabled in the portal.
The response isn't the format you expected	The `Accept` header must be exactly `application/vnd.masjidal.com.v1+json`. Some HTTP clients replace it with a default unless you set it explicitly.
Fewer days than you asked for, or none	Check both dates are `YYYY-MM-DD` and that `end_date` is not earlier than `start_date`.
It worked yesterday and fails today	Someone most likely rotated or disabled the key in the portal. Rotating takes effect immediately — generate a new key and update your server config.
Works locally, fails once deployed	The environment variable holding the key almost certainly isn't set on the server. Check your hosting platform's environment settings.

Need help? Contact Masjidal support from your portal account — and never include your key in the message.